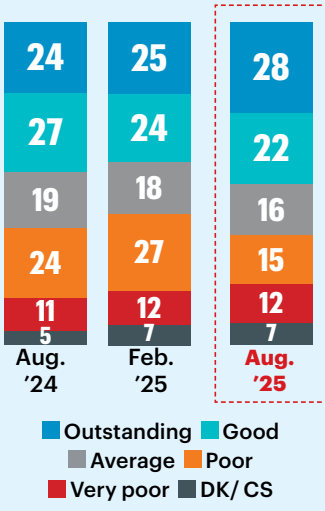
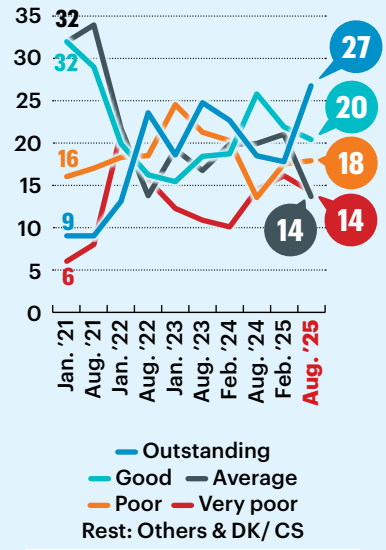
Q. How do you evaluate Rahul Gandhi's performance as Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha?



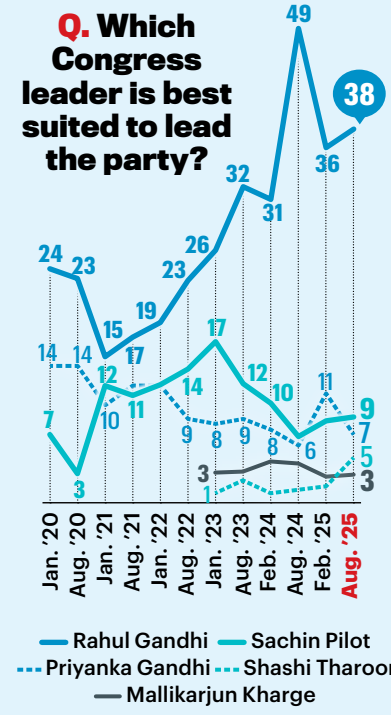
50% give thumbs up, helped by 12-point drop in the 'poor' rating since last poll in Feb.

Q. How would you rate the performance of the Congress as an Opposition party?



At 47%, this is the highest positive rating for the Congress since Jan. '21

Q. Which Congress leader is best suited to lead the party?



Rahul leads, but the post-LS poll high of '24 is still a mountain to climb

All figures in % and rounded off

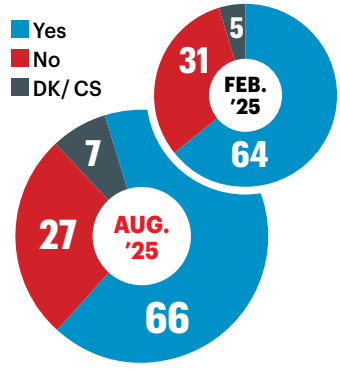
Yet the MOTN poll numbers also underscore the thin bench strength of the leadership behind him. Mamata, once projected as a rival power centre, has lost ground, while Kejriwal's sharp decline in the wake of corruption scandals and the loss in Delhi suggests that AAP's national ambitions are faltering. The INDIA bloc's dilemma, therefore, could not be clearer: it finds itself more dependent on Rahul even as uncertainty persists over whether he has the strength to carry the entire Opposition into a general election.

Perceptual Gains

Public perception of Rahul's performance as the official LoP marks a significant improvement. Over half rate him 'outstanding' or 'good', a sharp recovery from the last poll when 'poor' outpolled 'good'. The numbers hint at something important: the public now sees him not merely as a dynastic figure but as an institutional counterweight in Parliament. The Congress party itself presents a picture of gradual rehabilitation. The improvement in its public perception as an oppositional force—47.2 per cent now rate it 'outstanding' or 'good', compared to more modest numbers earlier in the year—suggests its more aggressive stance in Parliament and coordinated campaigns on economic issues have begun to bear fruit. Yet the fact that nearly a third of respondents still view its performance negatively highlights the depth of the challenge facing India's Grand Old Party.

Within the Congress, Rahul has clearly consolidated his position. The 38.3 per cent ayes for him to lead the party represent a steady climb from earlier this year, even as it falls short of the near-majority support he briefly enjoyed in 2024. In the poll for the most favoured non-Gandhi leader, the

Q. Is Congress the real Opposition party?



Two-thirds of those polled now see the party as the one to take on the BJP